

Instagram Posting Cadence

Guidelines for Feed, Reels, and Stories

AI Virtual Influencer Starter Kit

Instagram Posting Cadence

Guidelines for Feed, Reels, and Stories

These are **defaults for beginners**, not laws. Consistency beats the “perfect” time slot.

Recommended Frequencies

Launch (first 7–14 days)

Surface	Frequency
Feed or carousel	3–5 per week
Reels	3–5 per week
Stories	4–7 days per week (1–5 frames)
Total public posts	~1/day average

Steady state (after week 2)

Surface	Frequency
Feed / carousel	2–4 per week
Reels	3–5 per week
Stories	Most days
Soft promo	≤ 20% of feed/Reels

Minimum viable (busy weeks)

- 3 Reels **or** 3 feed posts
- Stories on 3 days
- One weekly batch session still happens

Format Mix

Aim for discovery + identity:

Goal	Lean on
Growth / reach	Reels
Brand grid / aesthetic	Feed 4:5 photos
Authority / saves	Carousels
Daily presence	Stories
Conversion	Stories + link in bio after value posts

Simple weekly recipe (example)

- 2 photo feed posts
- 1 carousel
- 3 Reels
- Stories on 5 days
- 1 soft promo somewhere in the mix

Timing Guidelines

Platform algorithms change. Use these as starting points, then trust **your** insights after 2–4 weeks.

Window	Why people try it
Weekday morning (local)	Commute / coffee scroll
Lunch	Midday break
Early evening	After work peak

Rules that matter more than the clock:

- 1. Post when you can engage for 10–15 minutes after.
- 2. Do not post five times in one hour then vanish for a week.
- 3. Keep a steady weekly rhythm.

Grid Rhythm

- Alternate calm portraits with busier scenes
- Avoid three promo posts in a row
- Keep colors loosely related to brand palette
- Profile should “read” niche in 3 seconds

Stories Cadence

Day type	Story ideas
Publish day	Behind the post, poll, "new post"
Off day	Mood, tip sticker, Q&A, poll
Promo day	Soft product frame + disclosure if needed

Keep Stories casual. They support the brand without needing perfect AI stills every time.

Secondary Platforms

Only after Instagram feels stable for 2+ weeks:

Platform	Cadence suggestion
X	3–7 short posts/week (repurposed hooks)
TikTok	3–5/week (Reels re-exported)
YouTube Shorts	2–4/week (same as TikTok/Reels)

See 09-0ps/repurpose-matrix.md.

Cadence Worksheet

My launch cadence:

My steady cadence:

Days I batch:

Days I publish:

Engagement window:

Promo days: